

MAS ALL ROUNDER

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ENG501 Midterm Short Notes BY PIN2 and MUHAMMAD (MAS All Rounder)

Q: Explain Linguistics briefly.

A: The scientific study of language and its structure, including the study of grammar, syntax, and phonetics. Specific branches of linguistics include

sociolinguistics, dialectology, psycholinguistics, computational linguistics, comparative linguistics, and structural linguistics.

Q- Define diachronic linguistics.

A- Diachronic linguistics is the scientific study of language change over time. It is the study of language through different periods in history. It maps the shifts, fractures and mutations of languages over the centuries.

Q- Language of law court.

A- French was the language of lawyers and the law courts down to 1362.

Q- Difference between inflection and derivation?

A- Morphology has two main subdivisions, namely inflection and derivation. Inflection deals with patterns of word structure that are determined by the role of words in sentences. Derivation creates new words with different meanings e.g., maltreat from treat.

Q- Role of literature in language.

A- Literature is a mirror of times and also a mirror of language/s used during the times. So for example, literature written in England during the Middle English period also reflects the times and language choices of the times.

Q- Anglicism. (*No such term found- Answer for the term 'Anglia')

A- The terms Angli and Anglia occur beside Saxons and refer not to the Angles individually but to the West Germanic tribes generally.

Q- Arbitrariness.

A- Arbitrariness: There is no 'natural' connection between a linguistic form and its meaning.

Q- Time of old English.

A- c.500 to c.1100

Q- Origin of word 'English'.

A- The word 'English' is derived from the name of the Angles (OE Engle) but is used without distinction for the language of all the invading tribes.

Q- Article in Middle English.

A- The definite article in ME is almost invariably 'te' or 'the'.

Example: 'te castles and bi the fet'.

Q: Status of Latin in 15th Century.

A: In the fifteenth century, English succeeds in displacing Latin as the general language spoken and written.

Q: What is language family tree?

A: A language family is a group of languages related through descent from a common ancestral language or parental language, called the protolanguage of that family.

Q: What John Barton wrote in his book in 15th century?

A: In the first decade of the fifteenth century, John Barton wrote a 'Donet François', a treatise intended for adults who wished to learn French.

Q: Two divisions in Celtic language.

A: The Celtic languages in England had two divisions: Gaelic or Goidelic branch and the Brythonic branch.

Q: Army and Navy examples in Middle English.

A: Control of the army and navy was in the hands of French people so naturally French military terms were used. Examples include: army, navy, peace, enemy, arms, battle, combat, skirmish, defense, ambush, retreat, soldier, garrison, guard, and spy. Also Officers: captain, lieutenant and sergeant are French words.

Q: English and England difference.

A: From the beginning, writers in the vernacular never called their language anything but Englisc (English). The word is derived from the name of the Angles (OE Engle) but is used without distinction for the language of all the invading tribes. From about the year 1000, the name England (land of the Angles) began to be used in place of Angelcynn. The name English is thus older than the name England.

Q: Difference between “Thee” and “Thou”.

A: Today we use you in both cases. In Old English, thou and thee were singular and ye and you were plural, but in Middle English times the custom arose of using ye/you as a polite or deferential way of addressing a single person, and this usage spread; thou and thee gradually dropped out of use in everyday speech, and finally disappeared (except in some dialects, where they persist to this day).

Q: Vowels in Old English.

A: Old English contains six vowel symbols a, e, i, o, u and y, and a seventh one, æ, called ‘ash’. All these represent both long and short vowels.

Q: French importance in 15th century.

A: Answer-1:

By the fifteenth century, writing French was less common whereas speaking French fluently was an accomplishment.

The importance of French language was waning.

Answer-2:

French being so long the mark of the privileged class was and is still:

- The language of culture
- The language of fashion
- The language of style
- The language of sophistication

Q: Why are Angles superior than Jutes and Saxons?

A: The Germanic tribes that conquered England were the Jutes, Saxons, and Angles. The original name of England means "Land of the Angles". Angles and Jutes were the first of tribes to invade Britain in large numbers. The Angles were established in England before the Saxons took over.

Q: What's a family tree?

A: The Family Tree Model

- First attempt at depicting the relationship between languages.
- It has assumptions:

1. The Regularity Hypothesis 2. The Relatedness Hypothesis **Q:**

Write About inflection and Derivation.

A: Morphology has two main subdivisions, namely inflection and derivation. Inflection deals with patterns of word structure that are determined by the role of words in sentences. Derivation creates new words with different meanings e.g., maltreat from treat.

Q: Indifference of noble class and kings.

A: They did not cultivate English, though had acquaintance with it.

The reason was that their activities in England did not necessitate it.

Their constant concern with continental affairs made French useful. **Q:**

John Wycliffe work.

A: John Wycliffe was the first person to translate the entire Bible into English. He died in 1384, and his translation probably dates from the last few years of his life.

Q: Vowels in Middle English.

A: Late OE and Early ME vowel-lengthening happened in Late Old English period but became apparent in ME period. In many cases the vowels were

shortened again during the ME period, but long vowels remained in some dialects, especially before the groups 'ld, mb and nd'.

Q: Role of language in literature.

A: In literature, a language displays:

- Its full power.
- Its ability to convey thoughts in a vivid form.
- Its ability to record emotions.

Q: Describe Inflectional affixes.

A: The process by which affixes combine with roots to indicate basic grammatical categories such as tense or plurality are inflectional suffixes (e.g. in 'cat-s', 'talk-ed', '-s' and '-ed').

Long Questions (5 marks each)

Q: English in post-independent Pakistan.

A: English is ideologically useful to the post-independence government of Pakistan trying to unify a newly established political entity, while at the same time carrying on the day-to-day tasks of education and administration. These factors favored keeping English as an official language. However, its retention was strongly opposed by religious parties 'who felt that maintaining the status of English symbolized a new form of colonization' (Mahboob and Ahmar, 2008, p. 245). They wanted an Islamic state with a local language. In response, successive governments in the first thirty years of the postcolonial period passed recommendations to develop and elevate the status of other languages, Urdu in particular, but did little to implement them before 1977.

Q: Define Morpheme.

A: A morpheme is a unit of meaning. It does not necessarily relate to the 'word count' or 'syllable count' of an utterance. Every morpheme can be classified as either free or bound. These categories are mutually exclusive, and as such, a given morpheme will belong to exactly one of them.

- Free morphemes can function independently as words (e.g. town, dog) and can appear within lexemes (e.g. town hall, doghouse).
- Bound morphemes appear only as parts of words, always in conjunction with a root and sometimes with other bound morphemes. For example, un- appears only accompanied by other morphemes to form a word. Most bound morphemes in English are affixes, particularly prefixes and suffixes. Examples of suffixes are -tion, -ation, -ible, -ing, etc. Bound morphemes that are not affixed are called cranberry morphemes.

Q: Define Phonology and Morphology.

A: Phonology is the study of how sounds are organized and used in natural languages. The phonological system of a language includes an inventory of sounds and their features and rules which specify how sounds interact with each other. Phonological development refers to forming and using speech sounds to clearly communicate language. As more sounds of a language are acquired, language becomes clearer as well as pronunciation, fluency, and intonation improves. There are approximately 44 speech sounds in English. Speech sounds used in combination with other speech sounds produce an oral language.

In linguistics, morphology is the branch of grammar devoted to the study of the structure or forms of words, primarily through the use of the morpheme construct. It is traditionally distinguished from syntax.

Q: Define the literature of Anglo-Saxon.

A: The literature of the Anglo-Saxons is the richest and the most significant of any preserved literatures among the early Germanic people. Two types of this literature were brought to England by the Germanic conquerors from their continental homes and preserved in oral tradition. It is influenced by reintroduction of Christianity into the southern part of the island at the end

of the sixth century. Two streams mingle in Old English literature; these are pagan and the Christian. Both the traditions constantly overlay.

Q: Define verbs in Middle English.

A:

- The principal changes in the verb during this time were the serious losses suffered by the strong conjugation. This conjugation, although including some of the most important verbs in the language, was relatively small as compared with the large and steadily growing body of weak verbs.
- An occasional verb developed a strong past tense or past participle by analogy with similar strong verbs. New verbs formed from nouns and adjectives or borrowed from other languages were regularly conjugated as weak.
- Nearly a third of the strong verbs in OE died out early in the ME period. Ninety of them have left no traces in written records after 1150. Some of them may have been current for a time in the spoken language, but except where an occasional verb survives in a modern dialect, they are not recorded. Its use was not governed by any strong sense and circumstances led to these changes
- So, it was natural that many speakers should apply the pattern of weak verbs to some of the verbs which were historically strong.

Q: Consequences of the Event in 1404.

A: An incident that occurred in 1404 seems at first sight to offer an extreme case. The king of France had refused to recognize Henry IV when he seized the English throne. Finally, an attempt was made to settle the matter by negotiation. In negotiations, the English ambassadors complained about the use of French. They asked to use Latin. Twice they spoke of French as being as unknown as Hebrew. Before middle of 15th century, it was necessary to have a 'Secretary in the French language' among the government officials. By the end of the century, Caxton could write: 'For the mooste quantyte of the people vnderstonde not latyn ne frensshe here in this noble royaume of england.'

Q: Write a note on Middle English?

A: The change in conditions after 1200 led to the re-establishment of English during the period of 1200–1500. Shortly after 1200 conditions changed. England lost an important part of its possessions abroad. The nobility gradually relinquished their continental estates. This led to a feeling of rivalry that developed between the two countries. An anti-foreign movement in England culminated in the Hundred Years' War. During the century and a half following the Norman Conquest, French had been not only natural but also more or less necessary to the English upper class. However, in the thirteenth and fourteenth centuries its maintenance became increasingly artificial. For a time, certain new factors helped it to hold its ground, socially and officially. Meanwhile, social and economic changes affecting the English-speaking part of the population were taking place. In the fourteenth century, English won its way back into universal use, and in the fifteenth century French totally disappeared

Q: Write a note on duality.

A: There are certain features of human language that distinguish it from other means of communication and Duality is one of them.

Duality: Human language is organized at two levels or layers simultaneously. We have a physical level at which we can produce individual sounds, like n, b and l, but beyond this we can organize a variety of sentences.

Q: Why Normans Adopted French?

A: The members of the new ruling class were sufficiently predominant to continue to use their own language. This was natural enough. For 200 years after the Norman Conquest, French remained the language of ordinary intercourse among the upper classes in England.

Normans readily adopted the French civilization. They injected fresh vigor into what they borrowed, profited from French military forces and took important features of Frankish law. Accepted Christianity and constructed Norman cathedrals. Locals gave up their own language and learned French. Consequently, Old Scandinavian tongue disappeared rapidly.

Second duke sent his son to Bayeux to learn something of the speech of his forefathers.

Q: Pronoun in Old English.

A: From the frequency of its use and the necessity for specific reference when used, the personal pronoun in all languages is likely to preserve a fairly complete system of inflections. Old English shows this tendency not only in having distinctive forms for practically all genders, persons, and cases but also in preserving addition to the ordinary two numbers, singular and plural, a set of forms for two people or two things — the dual number. Indo-European had separate forms for the dual number in the verb as well, and these also appear in Greek and to a certain extent in Gothic. They are not found, however, in Old English, and the distinction between the dual and the plural was disappearing even from the pronoun in Old English.

Q: Vowel sounds of Old English.

A: The pronunciation of Old English words commonly differs somewhat from that of their modern equivalents. The long vowels in particular have undergone considerable modification. Old English script normally uses sixteen consonant symbols, which in modern editions are usually reproduced as 'b, c, d, f, g, h, l, m, n, p, r, s, t, th and w'. Many of the symbols present no difficulty: the letters 'b, d, l, m, p, t and w' each represent a single phoneme which can be pronounced as in Modern English. Old English had no symbol v: the symbol 'f' was used to represent both [f] and [v]. The reason is that, in Old English, [f] and [v] were members of the same phoneme: they were allophones.

Q- Adjectives of Middle English?

A- By 1250 the strong declension had distinctive forms for singular and plural only in certain monosyllabic adjectives which ended in a consonant in Old English. Under the circumstances the only ending which remained to the adjective was often without distinctive grammatical meaning. Its use was not governed by any strong sense of adjectival inflection. By 1250 the strong declension had distinctive forms for singular and plural only in certain monosyllabic adjectives which ended in a consonant in Old English.

Under the circumstances the only ending which remained to the adjective was often without distinctive grammatical meaning. Its use was not governed by any strong sense of adjectival inflection.

Q- Old English facts and events.

A- Key Events in the Old English Period (c.500-c.1100)

- 449 Angles, Saxons, Jutes, and Frisians began to occupy Great Britain.
- 597 Saint Augustine of Canterbury arrived in England to begin the conversion.
- 730 The Venerable Bede produced his Ecclesiastical History of the English People, recording the early history of the English people.
- 787 The Scandinavian invasion began with raids and in 865; they occupied northeastern Britain and began a campaign to conquer all of England.
- 871 Alfred became king of Wessex, retaking the city of London, securing the kingship of all England for himself and his successors, and producing or sponsoring the translation of Latin works into English.
- 991 The English were defeated at the Battle of Maldon.
- 1000 The manuscript of the Old English epic Beowulf was written about this time.
- 1016 Canute became king of England, establishing a Danish dynasty in Britain.
- 1042 The Danish dynasty ended with the death of King Hardicanute, and Edward the Confessor became king of England.
- 1066 Edward the Confessor died and was succeeded by Harold, last of the Anglo-Saxon kings, who died at the Battle of Hastings while fighting against the invading army of William, duke of Normandy, who was crowned king of England on December 25.

Q- Old English words and nouns.

A- The inflection of the Old English noun indicates distinctions of number (singular and plural) and case. Thus the Old English noun has only four cases. The endings of these cases vary with different nouns, but they fall into certain broad categories or declensions. There is a vowel declension and a consonant declension, also called the strong and weak declensions.

Q- Weak and strong verb in the Middle English.

A- An occasional verb developed a strong past tense or past participle by analogy with similar strong verbs. New verbs formed from nouns and adjectives or borrowed from other languages were regularly conjugated as weak. Nearly a third of the strong verbs in OE died out early in the ME period.

Q: Five key aspects of Modern English period.

A:

- More modernized and less dialectal in written form
- Simpler inflection system
- Refined word order and prepositions
- Norman influenced spellings
- Enhanced grammar & vocabulary

Q: Difference between Synthetic and analytical languages.

A: All languages are either synthetic or analytical. A synthetic language shows grammatical relationships through inflectional change in the words, whereas an analytical language represents the grammatical relationships through word order. English was once synthetic but over time has become an analytical language.

Q: Any two experiments of origin of language. (Not sure about the answer)

A: - **The "bow-wow" hypothesis** (the most famous and therefore the most ridiculed hypothesis) holds that vocabulary developed from imitations of animal noises, such as: Moo, bark, hiss, meow, quack-quack.

- **The Natural Sound Source:** The fact that all modern languages have some words with pronunciations that seem to echo naturally occurring sounds could be used to support this theory. It has also been suggested that the original sounds of language may have come from natural cries of emotion such as pain, anger, and joy. We normally produce spoken language on exhaled breath.

Q: Syntax of Middle English.

A: Leveling of inflections resulted in syntactic and semantic relationships that had been signaled by the endings on words – now became ambiguous. There was a significant loss of inflections and later on, a corresponding rigidity of word order. This is the time when we notice a shift from a highly synthetic stage of Old English to the highly analytic stages of Late Middle English and Modern English.

Q: Old English overall language system and prefixes and suffixes in old English.

A: Old English exhibited a generous use of prefixes and suffixes. They were used to form new words from old words or to modify or extend the root idea. Prefixes in old English were a fertile resource in word building and particularly a feature in the formation of verbs.

Q: Synchronic Linguistics.

A: Answer-1:

Synchronic Linguistics is the study of a language at a given point in time. A synchronic approach considers a language at a moment in time without taking its history into account. The time studied may either be the present or a particular point in the past; synchronic analyses can also be made of dead languages, such as Latin. Synchronic linguistics is contrasted with diachronic linguistics (or historical linguistics), the study of a language over a period of time.

Answer-2:

Synchrony and Diachrony are two different yet complementary viewpoints in linguistic analysis. One can approach all different aspects of language, such as grammar, syntax, semantics, phonology etc., from two different points of view. Synchronic linguistics tries to understand the functioning of language at a single point of time without reference to earlier or later stages. Synchronic linguistics now usually precedes the study in terms of diachronic linguistics.

Q: Physical Adaptation Source.

A: The Physical Adaptation Source: Instead of looking at types of sounds, we can look at the types of physical features humans possess, especially those that are distinct. Some effects of this type of change can be seen in physical differences between the skull of a gorilla and that of a Neanderthal man from around 60,000 years ago.

Q: Describe tone, stress and juncture.

A: Intonation involves the following:

- Pitch – how high or low a voice is when producing a sound
- Stress – how low or soft a word is spoken
- Juncture – the pauses or connections between words, phrases, and sentences

Q: Vowel change in 12th century.

A: The Great Vowel Shift:

Beginning in the twelfth century and continuing until the eighteenth century (but with its main effects in the fifteenth and early sixteenth centuries) the sounds of the long stressed vowels in English changed their places of articulation (i.e., how the sounds are made).

Q: Adjectives in Middle English.

A: the form of the nominative singular was early extended to all cases of the singular. In the same way, the nominative plural to all cases of the plural is both in the strong and the weak declensions. The result was that in the weak declension there was no longer any distinction between the singular and the plural: both ended in -e (blinda> blinde and blindan>blinde). This was also true of those adjectives under the strong declension whose singular ended in -e. By 1250 the strong declension had distinctive forms for singular and plural only in certain monosyllabic adjectives which ended in a consonant in Old English. Under the circumstances the only ending which remained to the adjective was often without distinctive grammatical meaning. Its use was not governed by any strong sense of adjectival inflection.

Q: New stone-age.

A: Because the Stone Age was of long duration, it is customary to distinguish between an earlier and a later period, known as the Paleolithic (Old Stone) Age and the Neolithic (New Stone) Age. The Neolithic humans are distinguished by a high degree of artistic skill but representations on pieces of bone or the walls of caves tell us nothing about the language of their designers. They possessed a superior kind of stone implement and generally a higher culture. It was a dark race of slightly larger stature than the Paleolithic population.

Questions without Answers

Here is a list of questions we could not find the answers to within the handouts.

Q: Describe the Innate ability to communicate.

Q: Explain Expressiveness.

Q: Give two examples of acronyms.

Q: Describe Explicitness.

Q: Delusion of vowels and consonants.

Q: Define Art and culture of Middle English.

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Q1. How did the natives of West Saxon territory treat the Anglo-Saxon? 3 marks in the West Saxon territory, the invaders met with stubborn resistance and succeeded in establishing themselves only after much fighting.

Q2. What were the three linguistic achievements in English language. 3 marks

A Dictionary of the English Language, by Samuel Johnson, A.M. in 1755, in two folio volumes, was hailed as a great achievement.

Q3. Briefly describe the origin of Normandy 3 marks

Normandy (French: *Normandie*) is a region in the northern part of France. People from Normandy are called **Normans**. The name Normandy comes from the conquest and subsequent settlement of the area by the "Northmen" (Latin: *Northmanni*) also called Vikings. The band that settled at Rouen and became the Normans was led by Rollo.

Q4. Pronouns in Middle English with reference to the singular tu and plural ge.

The 'thou' form is used to refer to one person. However, Middle English adopted to some extent the French tu is used as singular by those of higher social status to address those of lower social status whereas the 'ye/you/ ge' form refers to more than one person as a polite or deferential way of addressing a single person, and this usage spread; *thou and thee* gradually dropped out of use in everyday speech, and finally disappeared

Q5. Write a note on literature of Middle English? 5 marks

Literature written in England during the Middle English period also reflects the times and language choices of the times. During the time, French was the language best understood by the upper classes, the books they read or listened to were in French. All of continental French literature was available for their enjoyment. The literature in English that has come down to us from this period (1150–1250) is almost exclusively religious.

Such incentives were most often found among members of the religious body, interested in promoting right living and in the care of souls. The separation of the English nobility from France by 1250 and the spread of English among the upper class are manifested in the next hundred years of English literature. Types of polite literature that had hitherto appeared in French now appeared in English. The period from 1350 to 1400 is a period of 'Great Individual Writers.' Geoffrey Chaucer (1340–1400) is the greatest English poet before Shakespeare. He is famous for his *The Canterbury Tales*. The general prologue of these tales provides a matchless portrait gallery of contemporary types. The varieties of the tales provide a veritable anthology of medieval literature.

Q6. Difference between inflection and derivation. 5 marks

Inflectional morphemes are affixes which carry grammatical meaning (for example, the plural -s in *cats* or progressive -ing in *sailing*). They do not change the part of speech or meaning of the word; they function to ensure that the word is in the appropriate form so the sentence is grammatically correct.

All inflectional morphemes in English are suffixes and are added after any derivational suffixes.

The most common inflectional morphemes are used in verb inflection (for example, *ed* in *raced*, *-ing* in *racing*, *-s* in *races*) but there are suffixes for noun inflection (for example, plural *-s* in *horses* and possessive *'s* in *Norma's*) and adjective inflection (for example, comparative *-er* in *faster* and superlative *-est* in *fastest*).

Derivational morphemes are affixes which are added to a lexeme to change its meaning or function. They are used to make a new, different lexeme (for example, *-ly* changes the adjective *sad* into the adverb *sadly*).

Most derivational morphemes change the part of speech, for example, *-ance* changes the verb *resemble* into the noun *resemblance*. Note that the 'e' is deleted at the end of the verb *resemble* when the suffix is added.

4. Facts about origin of language 5 facts.....5 marks.....

Over 400 million people use the English vocabulary as a mother tongue, only surpassed in numbers, but not in distribution by speakers of the many varieties of Chinese. Over 700 million people speak English as a foreign language. Did you know that of all the world's languages (over 2,700), English is arguably the richest in vocabulary and that the Oxford English Dictionary lists about 500,000 words, and there are a half-million technical and scientific terms still uncatalogued? Three-quarters of the world's mail, telexes, and cables are in English.

More than half of the world's technical and scientific periodicals are in English. English is the medium for 80% of the information stored in the world's computers. English is the language of navigation and aviation.

Five of the largest broadcasting companies in the world (CBS, NBC, ABC, BBC, and CBC) transmit in English, reaching millions and millions of people all over the world. **1.What is pitch, stress or juncture...3marks** Intonation involves the following:

- **Pitch** – how high or low a voice is when producing a sound
- **Stress** – how low or soft a word is spoken
- **Juncture** – the pauses or connections between words, phrases, and sentences

6. Morphological or synthetic features of middle English

A comparison of English texts written in the tenth or eleventh centuries with those produced in the late twelfth or early thirteenth reveals the following differences between Old and Middle English:

- phonological
 - Old-English diphthongs become Middle English monophthongs, e.g. *on heofonum* -> *in hevene*;
 - new diphthongs emerge in the Middle English period, e.g. *dæg* -> *dai*, *day*; ◦ [f, v] and [s, z], which were allophones in the Old-English period, become phonemes;
 - unstressed vowels in the inflectional endings become [ə]
- morphological
 - the complete Old-English inflectional system is simplified in Middle English;
 - loss of the strong inflexion of adjectives;
 - loss of grammatical gender;
 - emergence of the unified definite article 'the.'

- syntactical o replacement of the case functions by a fixed word order and prepositions.
- lexical o first borrowing of French loan-words; o increased emergence of Scandinavian loan-words.
- graphological o disappearance of Old English writing convention o increased use of Latin and Anglo-Norman.

5. Difference between synthetic and analytical languages. (5 marks) topic 33 A: All languages are either synthetic or analytical. A synthetic language shows grammatical relationships through inflectional change in the words, whereas an analytical language represents the grammatical relationships through word order. English was once synthetic but over time has become an analytical language.

Q. Write three articles of old English about domestic life 5 marks

Curtain, couch, chair, cushion, screen, lamp, lantern, chandelier, blanket, quilt, coverlet, towel, and basin indicate articles of comfort or convenience.

2. Role of Henry V after victory in 1415

made England one of the strongest military powers in Europe. Normandy became English for the first time in 200 years Henry V promoted the use of the English language in government[22] and his reign marks the appearance of Chancery Standard English as well as the adoption of English as the language of record within government. He was the first king to use English in his personal correspondence since the Norman conquest 350 years earlier

Q. Sources of Language The Natural Sound Source: The fact that all modern languages have some words with pronunciations that seem to echo naturally occurring sounds could be used to support this theory. It has also been suggested that the original sounds of language may have come from natural cries of emotion such as pain, anger, and joy. We normally produce spoken language on exhaled breath.

The Social Interaction Source: The sounds of a person involved in physical effort, especially when that physical effort involved interaction e.g., hums, grunts, groans. So, human sounds, however they were produced, must have had some principled use within social interaction. **The Physical**

Adaptation Source: Instead of looking at types of sounds, we can look at the types of physical features humans possess, especially those that are distinct. Some effects of this type of change can be seen in physical differences between the skull of a gorilla and that of a Neanderthal man from around 60,000 years ago.

The Tool-making Source: Some believe that manual gestures may have been a precursor of language.

IMP: The Genetic Source: At birth, the baby's brain is only a quarter of its eventual weight and the larynx is much higher in the throat, allowing babies, like that of chimpanzees, to breathe and drink at the same time.

6. Polialithic (Stone Age)

Stone Age was of long duration, it is customary to distinguish between an earlier and a later period, known as the Paleolithic (Old Stone) Age and the Neolithic (New Stone) Age. Paleolithic humans were the earliest inhabitants of England. They were short of stature, short-legged, with low foreheads, and poorly developed chins. They lived in the open under rock shelters or later in caves. The humans whose remains are found in the latest Paleolithic strata are distinguished by a high degree of artistic skill but representations on pieces of bone or the walls of caves tell us nothing about the language of their designers. 'Neolithic' is likewise a convenient rather than scientific term. They possessed a superior kind of stone implement and generally a higher culture. It was a dark race of slightly larger stature than the Paleolithic population.

1. Discuss the impact of science and technology on English language. (3 marks) topic 40 from video lecture.

Media and technology brings the world together and one can see English has emerged to be a common language used in the field of media and technology.

2. After the rise of middle class what happened to English language. Discuss briefly Since importance of a language largely depends upon the importance of people who speak it; with the rise of middle class English also had uplift in its status as their language.

English and England difference.

A: From the beginning, writers in the vernacular never called their language anything but Englisc (English). The word is derived from the name of the Angles (OE Engle) but is used without distinction for the language of all the invading tribes. From about the year 1000, the name England (land of the Angles) began to be used in place of Angelcynn. The name English is thus older than the name England.

Define Diachronic linguistics..3 marks

Diachronic linguistics is the scientific study of language change over time. It's also called historical linguistics. Principal concerns include: to describe and account for observed changes in particular languages. Diachronic linguistics is the study of language through different periods in history. It maps the shifts, fractures, and mutations of languages over the centuries. In gross outline, it is similar to evolutionary biology which maps the shifts and transformations of rocks.

5. Five features of language

1. **Displacement:** It is the ability to talk about times, places, and people other than the 'here and now': to say things which we know to be false.
2. **Arbitrariness:** There is no 'natural' connection between a linguistic form and its meaning.
3. **Productivity:** This is the ability to continually create new expressions and novel utterances. Creativity or open-endedness means that the potential number of utterances in any human language is infinite.

- 4. Cultural Transmission:** We may inherit brown eyes and dark hair but we do not inherit language. We acquire a language in a culture.
- 5. Duality:** Human language is organized at two levels or layers simultaneously. We have a physical level at which we can produce individual sounds, like n, b and l, but beyond this we can organize a variety of sentences.
- 6. What are the two kinds of Celts?(3 marks)**

Gaelic or Goidelic branch and the Brythonic branch. Celtic was probably the first Indo-European tongue to be spoken in England.

Q3. What is the difference between consonants of old English and Modern English? Old English script normally uses sixteen consonant symbols, which in modern editions are usually reproduced as 'b, c, d, f, g, h, l, m, n, p, r, s, t, v, and w'. Many of the symbols present no difficulty: the letters 'b, d, l, m, p, r, s, t, v, and w' each represent a single phoneme which can be pronounced as in Modern English. Old English had no symbol v: the symbol 'f' was used to represent both [f] and [v]. The reason is that, in Old English, [f] and [v] were members of the same phoneme: they were allophones.

Q4. Discuss the effects of Norman Conquest on English language. (5 marks)

The Norman Conquest greatly influenced the English language regarding pronunciation, vocabulary and grammar. It also had an impact on the loss of most Old English inflection during this period. The mixture of the two cultures and the two languages came to be known as the Middle English. The changes in the vocabulary involved the loss of a large part of the Old English vocabulary and the addition of many words from French.

i. The changes in English grammar are defined as a reduction of inflections.

For Example

In Old English, the word order was Adjective + Noun, some expressions like Royal Prince, changed into Old French pattern of placing a noun before its describing adjective like Prince Royal. Although nominal, there is evidence for French influence on English word order.

ii. French influence on the vocabulary

The French influence is observable on the English vocabulary. Many French words and idioms were introduced into English and are still used. As Normans started governing the churches and the courts of London the change first occurred in the courts and religious services, so these places were influenced first. For example

The largest single group among the words that were introduced in early was linked with the Christianity and church, where Normans took charge of the clergy ship (service, trinity, savior, virgin, angel etc.).

Words like state, royal (roial), exile (exile), army (armee), navy (navie), enemy (enemi), and more were joint in. French words were borrowed in English because of the ruling class and their fusion.

iii. French influence on spelling

A significant change in spellings took place for the sake of clarity. Old English 'u' changed as 'ou', for example, hus (house) as hous (ow when final).

Q4. Features of noun in Middle English?

In early Middle English, only two methods of indicating the plural remained fairly distinctive. At that time, it was difficult to predict that the *'-s' would become the almost universal sign of the plural* that it has become. Until the thirteenth century, the *'-en' plural enjoyed great favor in the south*, being often added to nouns which had not belonged to the weak declension in Old English. But in the rest of England, the *-s plural (and genitive singular) of the old first declension (masculine)* was apparently felt to be so distinctive that it spread rapidly. Fifty years later, it had conquered the rest of the Midlands, and by the 14th century, it had definitely been accepted all over.

Write a note on the black death 5 marks

It was in the summer of 1348 that in the Southwest of England, first case of this plague was reported. These were the first cases of a disease that in its contagiousness and fatality exceeded anything previously known. The Black Death spread rapidly over the rest of the country, reaching its height in 1349. 40 percent of the parish clergy died of the plague. Death rate during the plague approximated 30 percent. The effects of so great a calamity were naturally serious. Mortality was greatest among the lower social orders. The question arises why mortality was greatest among the lower social orders? The answer is simple: it happened because their life style was poor, hygiene conditions were bad and affordability to medicine was very low. The result of these deaths was a labor shortage which consequently gave rise to increase in wages.

Impact of the Black Death A general spirit of discontent prevailed. It culminated in the Peasants' Revolt of 1381. There was an increase in the economic importance of the laboring class. There was also an increase in the importance of the English language which they spoke. This also led to the rise of the craftsmen and the merchant class. By 1250, there had grown up in England about two hundred towns with populations from 1,000 to 5,000; some like London or York were larger. These towns became free, self-governing communities, electing their own officers, assessing taxes in their own way, trying their own cases, and regulating their commercial affairs. They were engaged in trade or in the manufacturing of crafts. Each town was independent, wealthy, and powerful standing halfway between the rural peasant and the aristocracy. Such changes in the social and economic life benefited particularly the English speaking part of the population.

Facts and Figures about English Language

Over 400 million people use the English vocabulary as a mother tongue, only surpassed in numbers, but not in distribution by speakers of the many varieties of Chinese. Over 700 million people speak English as a foreign language. Did you know that of all the world's languages (over 2,700), English is arguably the richest in vocabulary and that the Oxford English Dictionary lists about 500,000 words, and there are a half-million technical and scientific terms still uncatalogued?

Three-quarters of the world's mail, telexes, and cables are in English. More than half of the world's technical and scientific periodicals are in English. English is the medium for 80% of the information stored in the world's computers. English is the language of navigation and aviation. Five of the largest broadcasting companies in the world (CBS, NBC, ABC, BBC, and CBC) transmit in English, reaching millions and millions of people all over the world.

Q Why we should study History of English? Give reasons History

Helps Us Understand People and Societies.

Some knowledge of the roots of a language can sometimes help you understand the origin of a word.

Thirdly, some knowledge of the history of the English language will help you understand the rich variety of English literature that is available.

Q5. Why Urdu was not made the only official language?(3 marks)

All documentation was in English Language. For first 30 years this controversy went on. 1978 all schools were instructed to teach Urdu as medium. However schools continued to teach English. People who were in power continued to learn and interact in English. Because there wasn't any proper planning in bringing Urdu result was that English is used in official domains also the elite class. Urdu is currently 2012 is a national language. However, it couldn't get a real status of official language.

Q. Role of media in future development of English language 5 marks

Radio and motion pictures vs. telephone. Such additions to the vocabulary depend more upon the degree to which the discovery or invention enters into the life of the community. The same principle might be illustrated by film, radio, and television. *Cinema and moving picture (1899), screen, reel, film, scenario, projector, close-up, fade-out* are now common, and although the popularity of 3-D as a cinematic effect was short lived, the word is still used.

- *broadcast (itself), aerial, antenna, lead-in, loudspeaker, stand by, and solid-state etc.*
- *Words like **microphone**, and **transmitter** have acquired special meanings.*

There were also new meanings of *read, write, mouse, terminal, chip, network, workstation, windows, and virus.*

Q. Importance of London Standard*

By far, the most influential factor in the rise of Standard English was the importance of London as the capital of England. Importance of London Standard was due to certain reasons: London was, and still is:

- The political capital of England

- Commercial center of England
- Seat of the court of the highest judicial tribunals
- Focus of the social and intellectual activities London economy was especially important as

‘an engine of communication and exchange,’ which enabled ideas and information to be distributed and business to be done. The Spread of the London Standard In the latter part of the fifteenth century, the London standard had been accepted, at least in writing, in most parts of the country. Introduction of printing in 1476 was a reason and a new influence of great importance in the dissemination of London English. London was the center of book publishing. Caxton, the first English printer, used the current speech of London. In the sixteenth century, the use of London English had become a matter of principle as well as practice.

The process of development can be seen in the *Peterborough Chronicle*. Peterborough Chronicle was written in installments from 1070 to 1154.

1. Discuss the impact of science and technology on English language. (3 marks) topic 40 from video lecture
2. After the rise of middle class what happened to English language. Discuss briefly.(3 marks) topic 75
3. Describe the language property of arbitrariness.(3 marks) topic 2
4. Write 5 facts about English language present in your course.(5 marks) topic 19
5. Difference between synthetic and analytical languages. (5 marks) topic 33
6. Discuss the effects of Norman conquest on English language. (5 marks) topic 67 to 69
7. Describe Explicitness?

A- Explicitness dictates that you should be clear about the assumptions proven or unproven on which study is based.

2

8. Explain Expressiveness.

A- According to my understanding its the use words, phrases, gestures in written or spoken language. in case of written this is added by metaphors and idioms whereas in spoken body language, and intonation plays a vital role

9. Define Art and culture of Middle English.

A-The Middle English period (1150–1500). This was the time around loss of Normandy. to me logically the answer is: Lots of literature was translated from french to English. People were learning and inclining towards learning French as L2 keeping English as L1.

10. Q: Describe the Innate ability to communicate.

The human brain is hard wired to communicate. According to Chomsky Language learning abilities are built-in in human minds

11. Q: Give two examples of acronyms.

WWW: World Wide Web

ATM: Automated teller Machine.

12. What is the delusion (means difference) between vowel and consonants?

A- Vowel sound is made fairly open from the mouth. For example "a". Where as Consonant is fairly closed sound that is "m". So vowels are sounds produced by open configuration of vocal tract without audible friction. But consonants are produced in which sound is produced.

13. Define Anglicism?

A- An ****Anglicism**** is a word or construction borrowed from English into another language. For example words like computer and internet are borrowed from English in other languages.

Topic 059: Verbs in Old English

How many simple tenses did Old English verbs distinguish through inflection?

Old English verbs distinguished only two simple tenses through inflection: present and past.

What are the two main classes of verbs in Old English?

The two main classes of verbs in Old English are weak and strong verbs.

How did strong verbs in Old English differ from weak verbs in terms of vowel changes?

Strong verbs in Old English often had different vowels in the present tense, past tense, and past participle, while weak verbs typically had consistent vowels in these forms.

How did Old English verbs differ from Greek and Latin verbs in terms of inflection?

Old English verbs had a simpler inflectional system compared to Greek and Latin verbs. Old English verbs had only two simple tenses by inflection (present and past), and they lacked inflectional forms for the passive voice, unlike Latin or Greek.

Topic 060: Overall Language System in Old English

How were prefixes and suffixes used in Old English?

Prefixes and suffixes in Old English were used to form new words from existing ones, modify root ideas, and were particularly important in verb formation.

What language does Old English's use of prefixes resemble?

Old English's use of prefixes resembles modern German in word formation.

How were prefixes and suffixes employed in Old English?

In Old English, prefixes and suffixes were extensively used for word formation. They were used to create new words from existing ones, modify root meanings, or extend the root idea. This practice was similar to modern German and played a significant role, especially in verb formation.

Topic 061: Old English Literature: Phonology & Morphology

What is the significance of Old English literature among early Germanic people?

Old English literature is the richest and most significant among early Germanic peoples, showcasing both pagan and Christian traditions.

How did the reintroduction of Christianity influence Old English literature?

The reintroduction of Christianity at the end of the sixth century influenced Old English literature, resulting in the coexistence of both pagan and Christian traditions.

Why is the literature of the Anglo-Saxons considered the richest and most significant among early Germanic peoples?

The literature of the Anglo-Saxons is regarded as the richest and most significant among early Germanic peoples because it represents a blend of two traditions - pagan and Christian. It

showcases the full power of the language and its ability to convey thoughts vividly and record emotions. This literature was brought to England by Germanic conquerors and influenced by the reintroduction of Christianity in the sixth century. Both the pagan and Christian traditions constantly overlay in Old English literature.

Topic 062: Old English Literature: Semantics & Syntax

In Old English, what were the singular and plural forms of "you"?

In Old English, "thou" and "thee" were singular forms of "you," while "ye" and "you" were plural.

What happened to the usage of "thou" and "thee" in Middle English?

In Middle English, "thou" and "thee" gradually dropped out of use in everyday speech, replaced by "ye" and "you" for both singular and polite addressing.

How did relative clauses work in Old English?

Old English used "te," "se," or a combination of both for relative clauses, with "te" serving as "who" or "which."

How did the usage of pronouns like "thou," "thee," "ye," and "you" change from Old English to Middle English?

In Old English, "thou" and "thee" were singular pronouns, while "ye" and "you" were plural. However, during Middle English times, a custom arose of using "ye" and "you" as a polite or deferential way of addressing a single person. This usage gradually spread, causing "thou" and "thee" to drop out of everyday speech and eventually disappear. The shift from "thou" to "you" for both singular and polite addressing is a notable linguistic change.

Topic 063: Old English: Sample 1 & Discussion

What is the focus of the hands-on experience in this topic?

This topic focuses on analyzing an Old English text with different examples.

Why did Old English poetry have a large stock of conventional diction?

Old English poetry required alliteration, leading to a large stock of conventional diction with numerous words for warriors, weapons, and other elements.

What does this topic offer in terms of hands-on experience with Old English?

This topic provides a hands-on experience of analyzing an Old English text with various examples. It allows students to delve into Old English vocabulary and explore the nuances of the language.

Topic 064: Old English: Sample 1 & its Features

What does this topic primarily discuss and examine?

This topic discusses and examines phonological features and their representation in Old English texts.

What is the main focus of this topic related to Old English?

The primary focus of this topic is to discuss and examine the phonological features and their representation in Old English texts. It aims to provide a deeper understanding of the linguistic aspects of Old English.

Topic 065: Towards Middle English: The Norman Conquest (1066-1200) What is the significance of the prologue of the Anglo-Saxon Chronicle?

The prologue of the Anglo-Saxon Chronicle is a historical record of important events written in the ninth century.

How long is Britain island according to the text?

According to the text, Britain island is eight hundred miles long.

What languages are referred to as "brittisc" and "wilsc" in the text?

"Brittisc" and "wilsc" refer to the Celtic tribes that inhabited Britain, and they essentially represent the same language - Brito-Welsh.

How does the prologue of the Anglo-Saxon Chronicle relate to the history of the English language?

Answer: The prologue of the Anglo-Saxon Chronicle, written in the ninth century, is significant for understanding the history of the English language. It offers a word-for-word translation of early English text and provides insights into the languages spoken in Britain at the time. The mention of "brittisc" and "wilsc" in the text refers to the Celtic tribes inhabiting Britain, shedding light on the linguistic diversity and historical context of the period.

Topic 066: The Norman Conquest (1066-1200) Who were the Norsemen and Normans?

The Norsemen and Normans were two different groups of non-English speakers of Scandinavian origin.

What is the origin of the Norman Conquest in 1066?

The Norman Conquest in 1066 was led by William the Conqueror from Normandy.

How did the Norman Conquest influence the English language?

The Norman Conquest significantly impacted the English language, introducing French elements and changing its course.

What might English have been like if William the Conqueror had not succeeded?

Without the Norman Conquest, English may have retained more Germanic features and vocabulary.

How did the events of history affect the word stock of the English language?

The Norman Conquest added a significant number of French words to English, making it seem more like a Romance language.

How did the Norman Conquest in 1066 shape the English language?

The Norman Conquest of 1066, led by William the Conqueror, significantly influenced the English language. It introduced a substantial number of French loanwords and changed the course of English development. Without this conquest, English might have retained more of its Germanic characteristics and vocabulary.

What might English have looked like if William the Conqueror had not succeeded in the Norman Conquest?

Had William the Conqueror not succeeded, English would have likely followed a path similar to other Germanic languages, maintaining more inflections and a predominantly Germanic vocabulary. The enormous influx of French words that characterizes modern English vocabulary would have been absent.

Topic 067: Origin of Normandy & Norman Settlement

Where is Normandy located, and how did it get its name?

Normandy is on the northern coast of France and got its name from North-men who settled there in the ninth and tenth centuries.

How did the Normans adopt French civilization in Normandy?

Normans readily embraced French culture, including its military, law, Christianity, and language.

What was the state of Norman civilization at the time of the Norman Conquest?

At the time of the Norman Conquest, Norman civilization was heavily influenced by French culture.

How did William the Conqueror become King of England?

William the Conqueror became King of England after winning the Battle of Hastings and being crowned on Christmas Day in 1066.

How did the Normans assimilate French civilization in Normandy?

The Normans readily embraced French culture in Normandy. They adopted French military practices, incorporated key elements of Frankish law, accepted Christianity, and even built Norman cathedrals. Over time, they abandoned their Scandinavian tongue and adopted the French language.

What was the state of Norman civilization at the time of the Norman Conquest?

At the time of the Norman Conquest in 1066, Norman civilization was predominantly French in character. This was a result of extensive contact and interaction between Normandy and France, leading to a strong French atmosphere in the region.

Topic 068: Use of French Language and Literature

How long did French remain the language of the upper classes in England after the Norman Conquest?

French remained the language of the upper classes in England for approximately 200 years after the Norman Conquest.

How did the French language spread among the English population?

French spread through intermarriage, association with the ruling class, and social distinctions.

What language did the masses in England primarily speak during this period?

The masses in England primarily spoke English during this period.

How did the French language spread among the English population?

The French language spread through various means, including intermarriage, association with the ruling class, and social distinctions. It was largely the language of the elite, while the masses continued to speak English.

Topic 069: The Attitude Toward English

What was the attitude of the governing class in England towards the English language?

The governing class in England showed a preference for French over English, but it wasn't necessarily hostile to the English language.

What was happening with the English language until 1200?

Until 1200, English was not being cultivated and was considered the language of a socially inferior class.

Why were the king and upper classes indifferent to the English language?

Their constant involvement in continental affairs made French more useful, leading to their indifference towards English.

What was the attitude of the governing class in England towards the English language?

The governing class in England displayed a preference for French over English, but it wasn't necessarily hostile to the English language. However, English was considered an uncultivated tongue and the language of a socially inferior class.

What was happening with the English language until 1200, and why were the king and upper classes indifferent to it?

Until 1200, the English language was not actively cultivated by the ruling class and the upper classes. Their constant engagement in continental affairs made the use of French more practical. This indifference toward English was rooted in the utility of French in their activities.

Topic 070: Fusion and Diffusion of French and English

How rapidly did the fusion of Normans and English take place?

The fusion of Normans and English was rapid, especially during the reign of Henry I.

What evidence supports the rapid fusion of French and English in England?

Evidence includes Norman nobles identifying with England, founding monasteries, and choosing to be buried in England.

What was the language of the court and upper classes, and what language did the masses speak?

French was the language of the court and upper classes, while the masses spoke English.

When did the upper class begin to learn English, and how widespread was knowledge of French?

The upper class began to learn English over time, and French knowledge was more widespread among the upper class.

Topic – 071: Changes After 1200 & Loss of Normandy

What led to the re-establishment of English in the Middle English period?

Changing conditions after 1200.

What important event occurred in 1204 that affected England's possessions abroad?

The loss of Normandy.

How did the loss of Normandy contribute to the re-emergence of English?

It shifted England's focus from its continental possessions to becoming a nation.

What role did the Hundred Years' War play in the re-establishment of English?

It marked the culmination of anti-foreign sentiments in England.

When did French cease to be a prominent language in England?

In the fifteenth century.

What were the changing conditions after 1200, and how did they lead to the re-establishment of English during the Middle English period?

The changing conditions after 1200 were instrumental in the re-establishment of English in the Middle English period. These changes included England's loss of important possessions abroad, particularly the loss of Normandy. As the nobility gradually relinquished their continental estates, a sense of rivalry developed between England and France, culminating in the Hundred Years' War. During the century and a half following the Norman Conquest, French had been the language of the English upper class. However, its maintenance became increasingly artificial in the thirteenth and fourteenth centuries. Social and economic changes affecting the English-speaking population were also occurring, leading to the gradual return of English into universal use during the fourteenth century, ultimately causing French to disappear in the fifteenth century.

Topic – 072: Nobilities & French Reinforcement

How did the loss of Normandy affect the nobility in England?

It raised questions about their allegiance to England or France.

What decree in 1204–1205 accelerated the separation of interests between English and Norman nobles?

The decree by the king of France confiscating lands.

What did the king of France declare regarding people with possessions in both England and France in 1244?

They had to choose allegiance either to France or England, relinquishing their properties in one of the countries.

When did the nobility of England fully embrace English as their language?

After 1250, when they had no significant interests in France.

How did French reinforcement occur in England during Henry III's reign?

Foreigners, mostly from the south of France, settled in England.

What were the consequences of the loss of Normandy on the English nobility, and how did it affect their allegiance?

The loss of Normandy brought about significant consequences for the English nobility. It raised the question of whether many nobles owed their allegiance more to England or France. After the Norman Conquest, many nobles held lands in both countries, creating an interlocking aristocracy. However, the decree of 1204–1205 by the king of France, which confiscated the lands of several great barons, accelerated the separation of their interests. Families with estates on both sides of the Channel were compelled to give up one or the other. Some divided into branches or preferred their larger holdings in England, leading to the English nobility no longer considering itself tied to France after 1250. The use of French by the nobility diminished.

Topic – 073: English & French in the 13th Century

What language did the upper classes predominantly speak in the thirteenth century?

French.

How did French shift from a mother tongue to a cultivated tongue in this period?

It was supported by social customs, business, and administrative conventions.

When did English start becoming a language of general use among the upper classes?

By the middle of the thirteenth century.

How did literature change regarding language in the thirteenth century?

Works in French were translated into English.

What happened to the knowledge of French among English nobility in this period?

It became scanty, and some nobles spoke English as their mother tongue.

How did the language preferences of the upper classes change in the thirteenth century, and what factors contributed to these changes?

In the thirteenth century, the upper classes predominantly spoke French, as they had in the previous century. However, the reasons for using French were different. French transitioned from being a mother tongue inherited from Norman ancestors to a cultivated tongue. This shift was supported by social customs, business, and administrative conventions. Simultaneously, English was making steady advances. By the mid-century, when the English nobility had completed their separation

from French interests, English started becoming a language of general use among the upper classes. English words were adopted into the language, and literature was translated from French to English. By the end of the century, some children of the nobility spoke English as their mother tongue, necessitating the teaching of French through English glosses. However, the knowledge of French, even among those who attempted to use it, remained limited.

Topic – 074: The Hundred Years' War

When did the long period of open hostility between England and France, known as the Hundred Years' War, begin?

In 1337.

What prompted Edward III to claim the French throne and invade France?

France's interference in England's efforts to control Scotland.

What were the significant English victories during the Hundred Years' War?

Crécy (1346) and Poitiers (1356), followed by Agincourt (1415).

What marked the beginning of the end of English success in the Hundred Years' War?

The exploits of Joan of Arc in 1429.

How did the Hundred Years' War contribute to the disuse of French?

Answer: It reinforced the animosity between England and France and led to a decline in the use of French in England.

Q4: What events led to the long period of open hostility between England and France known as the Hundred Years' War, and what were its notable outcomes?

The Hundred Years' War, spanning from 1337 to 1453, emerged from the severed connection between England and the continent that had occurred over the centuries following the Norman Conquest. Edward III's claim to the French throne and his invasion of France were prompted by France's interference in England's efforts to control Scotland. Notable English victories at Crécy (1346) and Poitiers (1356) initially fueled English patriotism. However, this period of success was followed by reverses and long truces. In the reign of Henry V, England enjoyed another brief period of success, especially with the victory at Agincourt (1415). Still, this success waned after Henry V's death, and Joan of Arc's exploits (1429) marked the beginning of the end for England. The Hundred Years' War contributed to the disuse of French in England, reinforcing animosity between the two countries.

Topic – 075: The Rise of the Middle Class

What factors helped English recover its prestige during the Middle English period?

Improvement in the condition of the masses and the rise of a substantial middle class.

What event in 1349 had a significant impact on the laboring classes and the English language?

The Black Death.

Why did mortality from the Black Death affect the lower social orders the most?

Poor living conditions, hygiene, and limited access to medicine.

What was the result of the labor shortage caused by the Black Death?

An increase in wages.

How did the rise of the middle class benefit the English language?

The middle class contributed to the importance of English as their language, leading to social and economic changes.

What factors contributed to the recovery of the English language's prestige during the Middle English period, and how did the rise of the middle class impact it?

English language regained prestige during the Middle English period due to several factors. One crucial factor was the improvement in the condition of the masses. Villeinage was declining among the rural population, and fixed money payments replaced days' work. An event that greatly accelerated these changes was the Black Death in 1349, which caused a labor shortage due to high mortality rates, resulting in increased wages. The rising economic importance of the laboring class, who primarily spoke English, contributed to the language's significance.

Topic 076: General Adoption of English - 14th Century

Why did the general adoption of English in the 14th century occur?

It occurred due to the impact of the Black Death, which spread rapidly in monasteries and resulted in monks who spoke English replacing those who didn't.

How did the death of forty-seven monks and abbot St. Albans in 1349 contribute to the spread of English?

Their replacements were English speakers, accelerating the spread of the language.

What shift in language use occurred among writers during this period?

Writers shifted from using French to English.

Who were the primary speakers of French during this time?

French was mainly spoken by the educated classes and the French themselves.

Why did the general adoption of English in the 14th century occur?

The general adoption of English in the 14th century occurred due to several factors. One significant factor was the impact of the Black Death, which led to the rapid spread of English within monasteries. The death of forty-seven monks and the abbot at St. Albans in 1349 accelerated this spread because they were replaced with monks who were speakers of English. Additionally, there was a shift among writers from using French to English during this period.

Topic 077: English in Law Courts - 14th Century

What language was commonly used in law courts until 1362?

French was the language commonly used in law courts until 1362.

Which groups of people were known for speaking French during this period?

Lawyers, church officials, and the educated classes commonly spoke French.

When did the Chancellor first address Parliament in English?

The Chancellor opened Parliament with a speech in English in 1362.

When did English start to intrude into legal proceedings?

English began to intrude into legal proceedings in 1356 when the mayor and aldermen of London ordered proceedings to be conducted in English.

Topic 078: English in the Schools - 14th Century

What language had replaced English as the language of schools shortly after the Conquest?

French had replaced English as the language of schools.

When did English start to be used in schools again?

After 1349, English began to be used in schools, and by 1385, it had become a common practice.

Topic 079: Increasing Ignorance of French - 15th Century

What was the level of proficiency in speaking French among nobles in the fifteenth century?

By the fifteenth century, speaking French fluently was considered an accomplishment, and some nobles could not speak French.

What reasons were given for writing letters in English during this time?

People found English clearer than Latin or French for letter writing.

How did English ambassadors describe the use of French in negotiations with the French king?

They complained that French was as unknown to them as Hebrew and asked to use Latin instead.

What was the situation regarding the understanding of Latin and French by the end of the fifteenth century?

Latin and French were not widely understood, and there was a need for a "Secretary in the French language" among government officials.

Topic 080: French: Language of Culture and Fashion

What were the three reasons given by John Barton for Englishmen learning French in the fifteenth century?

First, to communicate with neighbors in France. Second, because many laws were in French. Third, because gentlemen and women wrote to each other in French.

What were the roles of French as a language in culture and fashion during this period?

French was the language of culture, fashion, style, and sophistication.

How has the perception of French as a language of privilege evolved over time?

This perception was strengthened in the eighteenth century and still exists in the minds of many people today.

What were the three reasons given by John Barton for Englishmen learning French in the fifteenth century?

In the fifteenth century, John Barton provided three reasons for Englishmen to learn French. First, it would enable them to communicate with their neighbors in the realm of France. Second, many laws were written in French. Third, gentlemen and women commonly corresponded with each other in French.

How has the perception of French as a language of privilege evolved over time?

The perception of French as a language of privilege has endured over time. While it was the language of culture, fashion, style, and sophistication in the past, this perception was further solidified in the eighteenth century and remains ingrained in the minds of many people today.

Topic 081: Use of Middle English in Writing

Why was Latin primarily used for written communication in the Middle English period?

Latin was mainly used due to historical habits, its international character, and its perceived stability compared to modern languages.

When did French start challenging Latin's dominance in written matter in England?

French began to challenge Latin's dominance in the fifteenth century.

When did English succeed in displacing both Latin and French in written communication?

English began to displace Latin and French in the mid-fifteenth century, around 1450.

Why was Latin primarily used for written communication in the Middle English period?

Latin was the preferred language for written communication in the Middle English period for several reasons. Firstly, it was a historical habit formed during a time when the majority of people who could write at all could only write in Latin. Secondly, Latin had an international character, making it suitable for communication across borders and cultures. Lastly, there was a perception that Latin was a stable and fixed language, while modern languages were seen as variable, unregulated, and in a constant state of change.

Topic 082: Middle English Literature

What language was most commonly understood by the upper classes during the Middle English period?

French was the language best understood by the upper classes.

What types of literature were predominantly available in English during the Middle English period?

Most literature in English from this period, around 1150-1250, was predominantly religious in nature.

Who is considered the greatest English poet before Shakespeare, and what is he famous for?

Geoffrey Chaucer is considered the greatest English poet before Shakespeare, known for "The Canterbury Tales."

Who is considered the greatest English poet before Shakespeare, and what is he famous for?

Geoffrey Chaucer, who lived from 1340 to 1400, is considered the greatest English poet before Shakespeare. He is renowned for his work "The Canterbury Tales," which offers a matchless portrait gallery of contemporary types and a diverse anthology of medieval literature through its various tales.

Topic 083: Changes in Pronunciation: Middle English

How do Old English (OE) spellings differ from Modern English spellings in terms of phonetics?

Old English spellings were phonetic, reflecting how words sounded, whereas Modern English uses more conventional spelling.

Why is Middle English phonology somewhat speculative?

Middle English phonology is speculative because it's based on written records, and dialects varied significantly over time and place.

How do Old English (OE) spellings differ from Modern English spellings in terms of phonetics?

Old English (OE) spellings differed significantly from Modern English spellings in terms of phonetics. OE spellings were primarily phonetic, meaning words were spelled based on how they sounded. There was no standardized system, and words were written according to their pronunciation, leading to variations in spelling.

Why is Middle English phonology somewhat speculative?

Middle English phonology is speculative because it relies on written records, and these records show that Middle English dialects varied greatly over both time and place. Unlike Modern English, Old English spellings were phonetic rather than conventional, making it challenging to precisely reconstruct pronunciation.

Topic 084: Middle English: Changes in Vowel Sounds

What happened to vowel length during the transition from Old English to Middle English?

Vowel lengthening occurred in Late Old English, but in many cases, these vowels were shortened again during the Middle English period.

Under what conditions did vowel lengthening not occur in Middle English?

Vowel lengthening did not take place if the vowel was immediately followed by a third consonant, as seen in words like "child" and "children."

What happened to vowel length during the transition from Old English to Middle English?

During the transition from Old English to Middle English, vowel length underwent changes. While some vowels were lengthened in Late Old English, many of them were shortened again during the Middle English period. However, long vowels persisted in some dialects, especially before consonant groups like 'ld,' 'mb,' and 'nd.'

Under what conditions did vowel lengthening not occur in Middle English?

Vowel lengthening did not occur in Middle English when the vowel was immediately followed by a third consonant. This explains the difference in vowel length between words like "child" and "children." Additionally, some words like "wind" retained short vowels due to analogy with words like "windmill," where the third consonant prevented vowel lengthening.

Topic 085: Comparison of OE & ME Spellings

Why did English spelling undergo significant changes during the transition from Old English to Middle English?

English spelling changed due to the Norman Conquest, which introduced new spelling conventions influenced by Norman French.

What impact did the Norman scribes have on English spelling during the Middle English period?

Norman scribes spelled English words as they heard them, leading to the emergence of many spelling changes not reflected in Old English.

How did the introduction of new consonant symbols affect Middle English spelling?

The introduction of new consonant symbols, like "g" for certain stops, marked a significant transition in Middle English spelling from Old English.

Why did English spelling undergo significant changes during the transition from Old English to Middle English?

English spelling underwent significant changes during the transition from Old English to Middle English due to the Norman Conquest. The Normans introduced new spelling conventions influenced by Norman French, disregarding traditional

English spelling. This led to many changes that had not been reflected in Old English spelling, resulting in a marked shift in the appearance of written English.

Lesson 18 THE GRAMMAR OF MIDDLE ENGLISH

Topic – 086: Middle English: A Period of Change

What marked the Middle English period in terms of language changes?

The Middle English period was marked by extensive and fundamental changes in the English language.

What contributed to these changes, besides the Norman Conquest?

Some changes were a continuation of tendencies from Old English, and the Norman Conquest accelerated the process by removing conservative influences.

What were the main types of changes during the Middle English period?

The changes primarily affected grammar and vocabulary.

How did Middle English grammar change during this period?

Middle English grammar changed from a highly inflected language to an extremely analytic one.

What happened to the English vocabulary during Middle English?

The Middle English period saw the loss of a large part of the Old English wordstock and the addition of thousands of words from French and Latin.

What were the main types of changes that occurred during the Middle English period?

The main types of changes during the Middle English period primarily affected grammar and vocabulary. Grammar underwent significant changes, reducing English from a highly inflected language to an extremely analytic one. Vocabulary changes involved the loss of a large part of the Old English word-stock and the addition of thousands of words from French and Latin.

Topic 087: Nouns & Pronouns in Middle English

What were the two methods of indicating the plural in early Middle English?

In early Middle English, the two distinctive methods of indicating the plural were 's' and '-en.'

How did the '-s' plural become predominant in Middle English?

The '-s' plural gradually became predominant in Middle English and replaced the 'en' plural in most dialects by the 14th century.

How did the decay of inflections affect pronouns in Middle English?

The decay of inflections simplified pronouns, making them less dependent on formal indications of gender and case.

What happened to the demonstrative pronoun forms in Middle English?

Middle English simplified demonstrative pronouns from the numerous Old English forms 'sē, sēo, þæt' to 'the' and 'that,' with 'those' (tho) surviving into Elizabethan times.

How did the methods of indicating the plural in early Middle English evolve?

In early Middle English, there were two methods of indicating the plural - '-s' and 'en.' Initially, it was difficult to predict that the '-s' plural would become the almost universal sign of the plural. Until the thirteenth century, the '-en' plural was favored in the south but was gradually replaced by the '-s' plural, which became predominant across most of England by the 14th century.

Topic 088: Adjectives in Middle English

How did Middle English adjectives change in terms of forms?

Middle English adjectives saw the leveling of forms, with the nominative singular extended to all cases of the singular and the nominative plural to all cases of the plural.

What was the consequence of this leveling of adjective forms?

The consequence was that in the weak declension, there was no longer any distinction between singular and plural adjectives.

How did Middle English adjectives change in terms of forms?

Middle English adjectives experienced a leveling of forms. The nominative singular form was extended to all cases of the singular, and the nominative plural was applied to all cases of the plural. As a result, in the weak declension, there was no longer any distinction between singular and plural adjectives.

Topic 089: The Middle English: Strong and Weak Verbs

What happened to the strong conjugation of verbs in Middle English?

The strong conjugation of verbs in Middle English suffered serious losses, with many strong verbs disappearing.

How were new verbs typically conjugated in Middle English?

New verbs formed from nouns and adjectives or borrowed from other languages were regularly conjugated as weak verbs.

What led to the application of weak verb patterns to historically strong verbs in Middle English?

The lower classes largely spoke this language, which was away from the restraining influences of education and literary standards, leading many to apply weak verb patterns to strong verbs.

What significant changes occurred in the conjugation of verbs during the Middle English period?

During the Middle English period, the strong conjugation of verbs suffered serious losses. Nearly a third of the strong verbs in Old English disappeared early in the Middle English period, with around ninety of them leaving no traces in written records after 1150. New verbs formed from nouns and adjectives or borrowed from other languages were regularly conjugated as weak verbs. Furthermore, the lower classes' language, which was less influenced by education and literary standards, led many to apply the pattern of weak verbs to some historically strong verbs.

Topic 090: Loss of Grammatical Gender

How was grammatical gender determined in Old English?

In Old English, grammatical gender was not often determined by meaning but by the concord of strong adjectives and demonstratives.

What happened to grammatical gender during the Middle English period?

The decay of inflections led to the elimination of grammatical gender in Middle English, with distinctive gender-indicating inflections disappearing.

How did grammatical gender function in Old English, and what happened to it during the Middle English period?

In Old English, grammatical gender was not often determined by meaning but rather by the concord of strong adjectives and demonstratives. These distinctive endings generally showed, at least in the singular, whether a noun was masculine, feminine, or neuter. However, the decay of inflections in Middle English led to the elimination of grammatical gender. The weakening of inflections and the confusion and loss of the old gender proceeded in a parallel course, albeit more rapidly in the North, where inflections dropped earlier. In the South, gender distinctions lingered longer due to a slower decay of inflections.

Topic 091: Middle English Syntax

How did leveling of inflections affect Middle English syntax?

Leveling of inflections in Middle English made syntactic and semantic relationships previously signaled by word endings ambiguous.

What shift in language structure characterizes the transition from Old English to Middle English?

The shift from highly synthetic Old English to highly analytic Middle English marks this transition.

How is the development of Middle English seen in the Peterborough Chronicle?

The Peterborough Chronicle, written from 1070 to 1154, shows a loss of inflections followed by a rigidity of word order, illustrating the development of Middle English.

Topic 092: Middle English Vocabulary

What was the influence of French on Middle English vocabulary?

French had a direct influence on Middle English vocabulary, leading to a considerable transfer of words between the two languages.

What areas of life were most influenced by French vocabulary in Middle English?

French had a significant impact on fashion, meals, social life, government, law, army, navy, art, medicine, literature, and science vocabulary in Middle English.

Topic 093: Borrowings in Middle English

How did the popularity of French words differ from Latin borrowings in Middle English?

French words were popular and widely used in everyday speech, while Latin borrowings were less popular and mainly entered through written language and learned circles.

Which century saw a proliferation of Latin borrowings in Middle English?

The fourteenth and fifteenth centuries were especially prolific in Latin borrowings.

Topic 094: The Rise of Standard English

What geographical region played a crucial role in the development of Standard English?

The East Midland district, especially around London, played a vital role in the formation of Standard English.

Why was the East Midland region influential in the development of Standard English?

The East Midland region represented a linguistic compromise, was populous, and hosted prestigious universities, making it less conservative than the South and less radical than the North.

Topic 095: Importance of London Standard

What factors contributed to the importance of London as a linguistic and cultural hub in the development of Standard English?

London's significance was due to its roles as the political capital, commercial center, judicial hub, and the focus of social and intellectual activities.

How did London's constant migration influence the English language?

The constant migration to London led to the mingling of other languages with the London idiom, resulting in reciprocal language influence.

When did the London standard become widely accepted in most parts of England, and what played a significant role in its dissemination?

By the latter part of the fifteenth century, the London standard was accepted, primarily in writing, and the introduction of printing in 1476 played a crucial role in its dissemination.

Topic 096: Middle English Sample and its Features

What are the predominant features of Middle English, as represented by Chaucer's language?

Predominantly East Midland with some Southern and Kentish features.

Give an example of a phonological change in Middle English as seen in Chaucer's writing.

The change of OE 'ā' to 'ō,' e.g., 'goon' for 'go.'

What Middle English text is commonly used to represent the dialect of London at the end of the fourteenth century?

Chaucer's language.

What is the dialect represented by Chaucer's Middle English?

Chaucer's Middle English predominantly represents the East Midland dialect of London at the end of the fourteenth century. It also contains some Southern and Kentish features, with Kentish features being slightly more prominent in Chaucer's work compared to non-literary London documents of the same period.

Topic 097: Middle English Sample Discussion

Which Middle English text from Geoffrey Chaucer's Canterbury Tales is used for examination in this topic?

A text from Geoffrey Chaucer's Canterbury Tales from 1387.

Mention a Middle English phonological feature observed in the selected text.

The unrounding of OE to 'i,' as seen in "swich."

What influence from the South is evident in the text?

The loss of '-n' in words like "unknown" and "write."

What are some linguistic features found in this Middle English text, such as the unrounding of OE to 'i' and the influence of Kentish 'e'?

This Middle English text exhibits linguistic features like the unrounding of Old English to 'i', as seen in words like 'swich'. Additionally, there's the influence of Kentish 'e', for example, in 'lest' (Old English 'lyst').

Topic 098: Activity Based on Sample

What is the source of the text used in this session to exemplify the features of Middle English writings?

The source is from East Midland, Cable, T. (2013), "Baugh and Cable's A History of the English Language."

Provide a translation of the Middle English passage about "cethegrande" (whale).

The cethegrande (whale) is a fish, the greatest that is in water; so that thou wouldst say, if thou saw it when it floats, that it was an island that set on the sea-sand.

Where is the text source used in this session from, and what is its purpose?

The text source used in this session is from East Midland, specifically from 'Baugh and Cable's A History of the English Language' by Thomas Cable (2013). It is used to exemplify the features of Middle English writings.

Topic 099: Phonological and Morphological Features: Middle English What is characteristic of early Middle English phonology?

It is not easy for modern readers due to its early Middle English phonological features.

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